

Fernando Barros de Mello

POSTDOCTORAL RESEARCHER, UC3M & INSTITUTO JUAN LINZ

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Academic Appointments

- 2023– Present **Postdoctoral Researcher (ERC Project “POLARCHATS”)**, Universidad Carlos III de Madrid & Instituto Juan Linz *Madrid, Spain*
- 2023 **Research Fellow & Visiting Professor**, Georgetown University *Washington, DC, USA*

Publications

† Denotes first-authored or single-authored work

PEER-REVIEWED JOURNAL PUBLICATIONS

11. **How Do Anti-Misinformation Laws Affect Electoral Campaigns? A field and survey experiment with Brazil’s politicians**, with Paul Atwell and Simon Chauchard. *Nature*, 2026. (5-year Impact Factor: 55).†
10. **When Business Speaks, Legislators Listen: Experimental and Qualitative Evidence from Brazil**. *American Political Science Review*, 2026. (5-year Impact Factor: 8.5).†
9. **Following the Leader Against Democracy? Evidence from the 2022 Brazilian Presidential Election**, with Ignacio Jurado. *Politics and Governance*, 2026. (5-year Impact Factor: 2.1).†
8. **The Roots of Brazil’s Partisan Divide: Debating Structural Inequalities of Race, Class, and Gender**, with David Samuels, Larissa Beckman, and Cesar Zucco. *Latin American Politics and Society*, 2026. (5-year Impact Factor: 2.0).
7. **Does the Style of Misinformation Condition its Effects? An Experiment in Brazil**, with Rodrigo Fernández Caba and Simon Chauchard. *The Journal of Politics*, 2025. (5-year Impact Factor: 4.3).
6. **Partisan Stereotyping and Polarization in Brazil**, with David Samuels and Cesar Zucco. *Latin American Politics and Society*, 2024. (5-year Impact Factor: 2.0).
5. **To Democracy through Anocracy**, with Josep Colomer and David Banerjee. *Democracy & Society*, 2016.

BOOKS, BOOK CHAPTERS, AND DATASETS

4. **States and Institutions of Governance in Latin America**, with Diana Kapiszewski et al. *Georgetown University (dataset)*. Available at: <https://sigla.georgetown.domains/gateway/>.
3. **Lobbying Uncovered: Corruption, Democracy, and Public Policy in Brazil**, with Milton Seligman. *Wilson Center*, 2023.
2. **Grupos Organizados, Corrupção e Anticorrupção no Brasil**, with Daniel Marcelino. In *Corrupção: Diálogos Interdisciplinares*. São Paulo: Almedina, 2020.
1. **O Jornalismo como Ferramenta de Controle da Corrupção**, with Laura Diniz. In *48 Visões sobre a Corrupção*. São Paulo: Quartier Latin, 2017.

REVISE & RESUBMIT

- “**That Could Be Me**”: **Fear of Sending-Country Chaos Can Drive Immigration Attitudes**, with David Samuels, Ignacio Jurado, and Cesar Zucco. (Under review, *American Journal of Political Science*).

UNDER REVIEW

- Pork-Barrel Without Attribution: The Rise of Credit Disclaiming in Brazil**, with Marcus Melo. (Under review, *Comparative Political Studies*)†

WORKING PAPERS AND PRE-ANALYSIS PLANS (PAPs)

- Political Attitudes and Perceptions of Status Gain and Loss: Evidence from Brazil**, with David Samuels and Cesar Zucco.

Political Attitudes and Rio de Janeiro, with xxxxx.

Bahia, with xxxxx.

Shaping Online Public Opinion: Micro-Influencing Strategies in Brazil, with Priyadarshi Amar and Simon Chauchard (Pre-Analysis Plan).

Journalism, Awards, and Professional Experience _____

AWARDS

- 2014 **Best Latin American Investigative Reporting**, Institute for Press and Society (IPYS)
- 2013 **In-Depth Reporting Award**, Inter American Press Association (IAPA)
- 2013 **Eso Award for Most Important Contribution to the Brazilian Press**
- 2011 **Best Politics Article**, Abril Award
- 2010 **Interview of the Year (with President Fernando Henrique Cardoso)**, Abril Award

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Co-founder & Data Director, JOTA.info. Leading Brazilian legal and political data platform; named Best Digital Media Startup in the World (WAN-IFRA, 2019).

Political & Investigative Reporter, Folha de São Paulo (2011–2013). Covered the Presidency, National Congress, and 2012 municipal elections.

Political Reporter, VEJA Magazine (2010–2011). Covered the 2010 presidential election and National Congress.

Education _____

University of California, Los Angeles (UCLA) *Los Angeles, CA, USA*
PH.D. IN POLITICAL SCIENCE *Dec 2022*

University of California, Los Angeles (UCLA) *Los Angeles, CA, USA*
M.S. IN STATISTICS *Mar 2023*

Georgetown University *Washington, DC, USA*
M.A. IN LATIN AMERICAN STUDIES AND GOVERNMENT *Dec 2016*

University of São Paulo *São Paulo, Brazil*
B.A. IN JOURNALISM AND POLITICAL SCIENCE *Dec 2010*

Awards, Fellowships, & Grants _____

2025	Juan de la Cierva Postdoctoral Fellowship (awarded, declined) , Spanish Ministry of Science and Innovation	\$35,000
2023	Research Grant , Fundação Tide Setúbal	\$25,000
2022	Research Grant , JOTA / YouTube	\$30,000
2022	Dissertation Year Fellowship , University of California, Los Angeles (UCLA)	\$20,000
2021	Summer Mentored Research Fellowship (SMRF) , University of California, Los Angeles (UCLA)	\$6,000
2019	Swarr Prize for Best Unpublished Paper (Political Science) , University of California, Los Angeles (UCLA)	\$500
2017	Tinker Field Research Grant , Tinker Foundation	\$2,500
2016	Dean's Scholarship , University of California, Los Angeles (UCLA)	\$15,000
2015	Research Grant , Georgetown University	\$1,500

Teaching Experience _____

2025	Applied Quantitative Methods for the Social Sciences , Instructor of Record	UC3M
2024	Comparative Politics (Groups 58, 68, 69) , Instructor of Record	UC3M
2023	LASP 503: States & Society , Instructor of Record	Georgetown
2023	GOVT 4456: Latin American Government and Politics , Instructor of Record	Georgetown
2021	PS 50: Introduction to Comparative Politics , Instructor of Record	UCLA
2017–2020	PS 50: Introduction to Comparative Politics , Teaching Assistant	UCLA
2017, 2021	PS 30: Game Theory , Teaching Assistant	UCLA
2018, 2021	PS 115: Russian Politics , Teaching Assistant	UCLA
2019	PS 6: Data Analysis , Teaching Assistant	UCLA

Total teaching hours: approximately 570

Average teaching evaluation: 8.0 / 9 (≈4.4 / 5)
Excellence Acknowledgement: (UC3M, 03/2025)

Teaching

Professional Service

Ad hoc reviewer for *The Journal of Politics*, *Comparative Political Studies*, *Latin American Research Review*, *Dados*, and *Latin American Politics and Society*.

Participation at Conferences and Meetings

2026	Annual Meeting (Boston) , American Political Science Association (APSA)	Full paper
2026	Annual Meeting (Chicago) , Midwest Political Science Association (MPSA)	Full paper
2025	Annual Meeting (Vancouver) , American Political Science Association (APSA)	Full paper
2025	Annual Meeting (Madrid) , European Political Science Association (EPSA)	Full paper
2025	Annual Meeting (Chicago) , Midwest Political Science Association (MPSA)	Full paper
2025	Digital Democracy Workshop (Zurich) , University of Zurich	Full paper
2024	Annual Meeting (Philadelphia) , American Political Science Association (APSA)	Full paper
2024	Annual Meeting (Cologne) , European Political Science Association (EPSA)	Full paper
2024	10th Anniversary Conference , IC3JM	Full paper
2023	Annual Meeting (Los Angeles) , American Political Science Association (APSA)	Full paper
2023	Annual Meeting , Southern Political Science Association (SPSA)	Full paper
2022	Annual Meeting (Chicago) , Midwest Political Science Association (MPSA)	Full paper
2022	Annual Meeting (Montreal) , American Political Science Association (APSA)	Full paper
2021	Annual Meeting (Online) , Midwest Political Science Association (MPSA)	Full paper
2019	Annual Meeting (Washington, DC) , American Political Science Association (APSA)	Full paper

SELECTED INVITED TALKS

2025	Invited Speaker , University of Copenhagen	In Person
2022	Invited Speaker , Texas A&M University	Online
2019, 2026	Invited Speaker , Insper (São Paulo, Brazil)	In Person
2018	Invited Speaker , Atlantic Council (Washington, DC)	In Person

References

UCLA – Department of Political Science DR. BARBARA GEDDES • geddes@ucla.edu	Los Angeles, CA
UCLA – Department of Political Science DR. MICHAEL THIES • thies@polisci.ucla.edu	Los Angeles, CA
Columbia University DR. CESAR ZUCCO • cz2972@columbia.edu	New York, NY
Universidad Carlos III de Madrid & Juan Linz Institute DR. SIMON CHAUCHARD • simon.chauchard@uc3m.es	Madrid, Spain